was served with an expulsion order and sent over to Pakistan via Kohala. In Pakistan, he joined Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan and started living in Murree. Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan appointed Mittha as the Director of Public Relations of the Azad Kashmir Government, even before the said government was announced.

Another journalist, G. K. Reddy, who was the Resident Editor of *Kashmir Times* in the 1940s, also served as the Correspondent for the Associated Press in Srinagar.[2] He used to report to its Lahore chief, Malik Tajuddin. Reddy was detained at Domel near Muzaffarabad for 10 days in mid-October 1947. After that, he was transported to Kathua, escorted by the military, and expelled from the state at the Pathankot border. The same day, he drove straight to Lahore and reported the whole story to Malik Tajuddin. News of the expulsion of Mittha and Reddy was flashed on Pakistan press outlets and announced on the radio. Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan promptly appointed Reddy as the Deputy Director of Public Relations of the Azad Kashmir Government. While in Lahore, on 21 October 1947, Reddy received a phone call from Lt. Col. Alavi, the Public Relations Officer of the Pakistan Army, who stated that the Ramkot post of the Jammu and Kashmir Government was being attacked that night. This news, he demanded, should be published as coming from the Azad Kashmir Headquarters in Pallandri. Reddy was also told that all further news of invasion would come from the Army Headquarters in Rawalpindi, but Pallandri is the place that should be mentioned in all press releases. Reddy hated the Maharaja, and this prompted him to give a detailed interview on 26 October 1947 to the Lahore-based daily *Civil and Military Gazette*, where he described the ‘mad orgy of Dogra violence’ against Muslims in Jammu.

Endgame for Hari Singh

Little did Maharaja Hari Singh know that the crimson-coloured leaves of the valley’s Chinar trees would end up being a metaphor for the blood of all